

“That was the strongest chain we’ve ever made,” Odin said.
“But we must bind the wolf before he brings disaster down on us.”

“The dwarfs are the best smiths in the Nine Worlds,” Freya offered. “Only they can create a bond strong enough to hold Fenrir.”

So the request was sent to the mines in Nidavellir, the home of the dwarfs, deep down underground.

For days the dwarfs laboured to complete a chain not of metal, but of the sound of a cat’s footsteps, the beard of a woman, the roots of a mountain, the breath of a fish, and the spittle of a bird – things that don’t exist and so against which no one, not even Fenrir, could struggle. It was called Gleipnir.

“It doesn’t even look like a chain,” Odin said, examining it with his one keen eye. “It’s like a length of ribbon.”

“But is it strong?” Freya asked.

“Let’s see,” Odin said, and he called out to the wolf: “Oh, Fenrir! Would you like to test your strength again?”

*Fenrir sniffed the ribbon suspiciously.
“It’s like no chain I’ve ever seen before,”
he growled. “I sense trickery.”*

“No trickery,” Odin said.
“You have my word.”

“Not good enough. As a gesture of good faith, I want one of you to put their hand in my mouth while I try to escape.”

